



VR'S THE WORD



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“Analysts” have declared every year since 2014 as the year of the VR and they’ve been proven wrong each and every time. Heck, that’s what an analyst’s job is – to be wrong 90 per cent of the time and be correct 10 per cent of the time, partly due to chance. We kid. But 2016 is truly the year of the VR. AMD and NVIDIA have both come out with pretty strong offerings to capitalise on the VR space. NVIDIA’s Pascal has already debuted with two flagships – the GTX 1080 and the GTX 1070 and by the time you get this issue, AMD will have its Polaris based RX 480, RX 470 and RX 460 out. The difference here is that NVIDIA’s offerings are really expensive and AMD’s aren’t so by the look of things, it seems that AMD is going to sweep the mid-range segment in the coming months. However, we’d rather not count all our chickens before they hatch, so we’ll wait till the actual launch to opine on the subject. Meanwhile, let’s look at what new technologies have come forth.

More buzz words!

Let’s start with VR. NVIDIA had a head-

start with their GTX 970 and GTX 980 which were even cited by multiple VR headset manufacturers as the bare minimum and AMD’s offerings weren’t exactly making the cut. AMD then swooped in and stole the show with Project Quantum which had dual Fury X GPUs. Unfortunately, we never saw the unit here in India. So between the ridiculously priced 970s, 980s and the Quantum that never surfaced, 2015 was never cut out to be the year of the VR.

Come 2016, and we saw Pascal getting launched and it totally changed the ecosystem, at least, it did so overseas. The ridiculous pricing in India pretty much ensured that the GTX 1080 was a normal flagship launch and nothing spectacular. The GTX 1070, on the other hand, is a lot more favourable priced, overseas, that

is. And then it’s AMD’s turn. As the time of writing this article, we know that the RX 480 is priced at \$199 which works out to ₹14,000 and for that price it will be a remarkable GPU. Even if we bring taxation into the picture we are looking at roughly ₹18,900 for the RX 480. Unconfirmed leaks have shown the RX 480 to be really powerful with two in CrossFire even beating the GTX 1080 in certain DX12 games. So for ₹37,800 you’ll have, allegedly, a better GPU configuration than the GTX 1080 which costs ₹63,250. It sounds too sweet to be true and we’ll only know the full of it after the official launch.

Both AMD and NVIDIA have bigger bombs in their arsenal, NVIDIA has the GP100 of which they’ll probably release a GP106 or a GP204 and AMD has VEGA up its sleeve. There’s hardly ever been so much